

One big cover up

Many polar animals have thick coats. The snowy owl has feathers on its body that grow long enough to cover its legs and its bill.

Snowy owl



A fine fur coat

The Arctic fox's luxurious fur even covers the soles of its feet. This fox is dark in the summer, and white in the winter. In the summer it is very busy, collecting and storing food for the winter.

Cushion growth

It's not just animals that need to wrap up warm – plants do too. Purple saxifrage has lots of tiny, overlapping leaves that completely cover the short stems.



Purple saxifrage is one of the first Arctic plants to flower when the snow melts in June.

The snowy owl's talons are perfectly shaped for gripping a lemming.

Polar regions are dark for half the year, but many animals survive.

Lemmings cope with the cold by staying in tunnels below the snow, where they hunt for plant roots to nibble. If they emerge, they may well be caught by a passing snowy owl.

Become an expert

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